Pradesh which were hit by the ban against matched regions elsewhere in India which were not hit by the ban. [2]

It takes time to develop sound measurement systems

Tiger conservation leaped into prominence with the establishment of Project Tiger in 1972. It took about thirty years to lay the foundations of measurement.

Important new developments took place in this field from 2002 to 2006. Every four years since 2006, the Indian government conducts a national census of tigers and other wildlife. The ‘All-India Tiger Estimation Report 2018’ was prepared by the National Tiger Conservation Authority (NTCA) in collaboration with the Wildlife Institute of India (WII), the World Wide Fund-India (WWF-I), state forest departments and many volunteers and non-profit organizations.

The most recent survey deployed 44,000 field staff who conducted habitat surveys across the twenty tiger-occupied states of India, checking some 381,400 sq. km for tigers and their prey. The team placed paired camera traps at 26,838 locations across 139 study sites, which collected 34.8 million photos. The WII and NCTA developed the methodology for conducting the tiger survey after extensive consultations with experts and through a rigorous peer-review process. The methodology combines field combing to record carnivore tracks, remote sensing data, hidden cameras, four indigenously developed software systems, including one that tracks tiger flank stripe patterns, and DNA profiling.

None of this is cast in stone. An active debate continues to take place, in the intellectual community, about the strengths and weaknesses of the measurement programme. Iterative refinement is taking place based on these debates. The only trusted measurement system is one that is continuously scrutinized, criticized and refined.

This work is an example of the long and slow process required in laying the foundations of measurement, of deep collaboration between the state